

Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

Lab 2 — Reflection Document

Project	Alumni Mentorship & Mock Interview Platform
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Course / Lab	Software Engineering — Lab 2
Tool	Jira (Scrum, company-managed project: Alumni-Mentorship, key AM)

1. Work Carried Out

The functional requirements identified in Lab 1 (FR-001 to FR-005) and the non-functional requirements (NFR-001, NFR-002) were converted into an Agile backlog and run through two simulated sprints in Jira. The steps followed were:

1. **Set up the Jira project.** Created a Scrum project (Software development → Scrum, company-managed) named Alumni-Mentorship with key AM.
2. **Created Epics.** Grouped the Lab 1 requirements into five major themes: Mentor Discovery & Matching, Availability Management, Session Booking, Interview Feedback & Scorecards, and Privacy & Performance.
3. **Wrote User Stories.** For each Epic, wrote stories in the format “As a [role], I want [goal], so that [benefit]” and linked each to its Epic, using the Student Mentee and Alumni Mentor actors from Lab 1.
4. **Prioritised the backlog.** Assigned High, Medium, or Low priority to every story based on user impact, and reordered the backlog so the booking-critical stories sit at the top.
5. **Assigned Story Points.** Estimated each story on the Fibonacci scale (1, 2, 3, 5, 8) for complexity, effort, and uncertainty, using the planning-poker approach. All stories were estimated before the sprint was started.
6. **Planned and ran Sprint 1.** Created a 1-week sprint, dragged the selected stories into it, started it, and moved the stories To Do → In Progress → Done before completing the sprint.
7. **Planned and ran Sprint 2.** Repeated the same process for the booking stories and completed the second sprint.
1. **Generated the Burndown Chart.** Opened Reports → Burndown Chart, selected each sprint with Story Points as the estimation statistic, and reviewed remaining work against the guideline.
2. **Answered the reflection questions** (Section 4) and prepared the submission screenshots (Section 5).

2. Epics, User Stories, Priority and Story Points

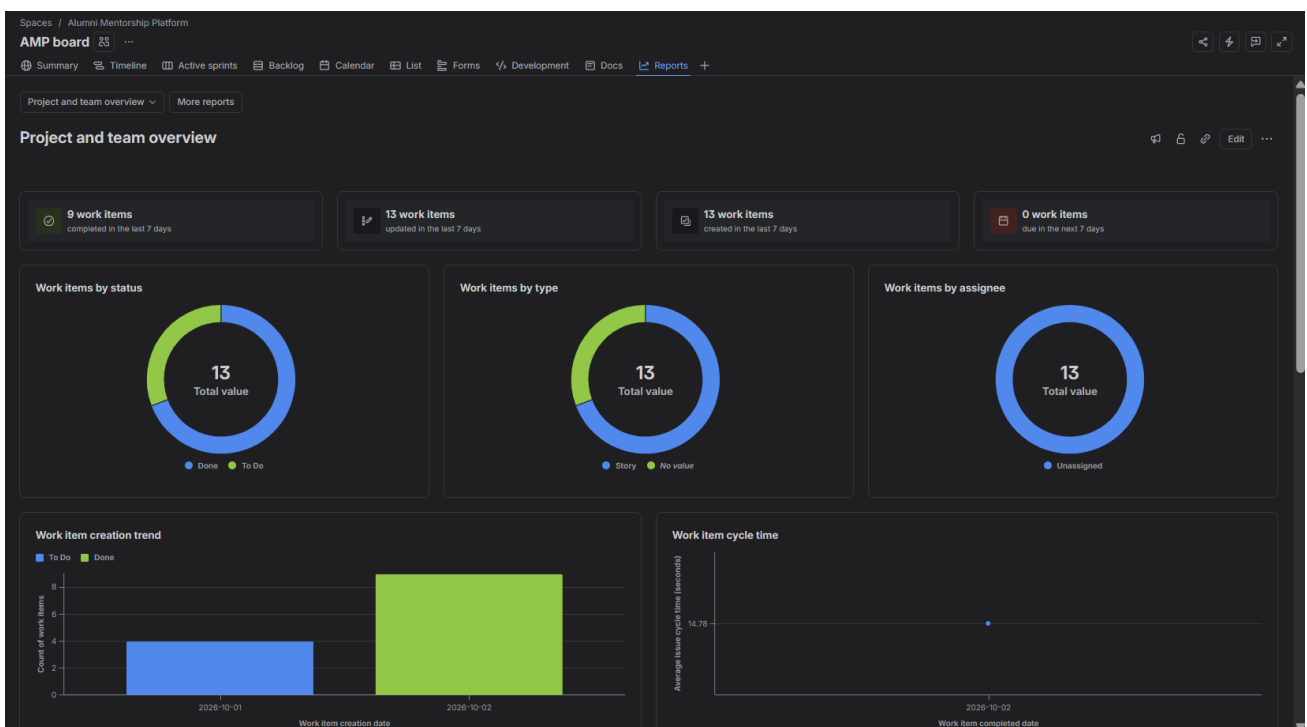
Epic 1: Mentor Discovery & Matching (FR-001)				
1.1	Domain Selection	As a student, I want to select a domain (e.g. Embedded Systems, Cloud Computing), so that I see mentors in my area of interest.	High	3
1.2	Ranked Recommendations	As a student, I want mentors ranked by relevance to my domain, so that I can quickly find the best fit.	High	8
1.3	Mentor Profile	As a student, I want to view a mentor's profile and expertise, so that I can decide whom to book.	Medium	3
1.4	No-Match Fallback	As a student, I want related domains suggested when nothing matches, so that my search isn't a dead end.	Low	2
Epic 2: Availability Management (FR-002, FR-004)				
2.1	View Mentor Slots	As a student, I want to see a mentor's available time slots, so that I can pick a time that suits me.	High	5
2.2	Manage My Slots	As a mentor, I want to add, edit, or remove my available slots, so that my availability stays accurate.	Medium	5
2.3	Live Slot Updates	As a student, I want slot changes to appear immediately, so that I never see a stale slot.	Medium	3
Epic 3: Session Booking (FR-001, FR-003)				
3.1	Book a Session	As a student, I want to book a mentorship or mock-interview slot, so that I can reserve time with a mentor.	High	8
3.2	Prevent Double-Booking	As a mentor, I want booked slots locked instantly, so that I'm never booked twice.	High	5
3.3	Calendar & Meeting Link	As a student, I want the session on both calendars with a meeting link, so that we can both join easily.	High	8
3.4	Booking Confirmation	As a student, I want a confirmation after booking, so that I know it succeeded.	Medium	2
Epic 4: Interview Feedback & Scorecards (FR-005)				
4.1	Submit Scorecard	As a mentor, I want to record a structured scorecard after a session, so that the student gets clear feedback.	Medium	5
4.2	View Feedback	As a student, I want to view the scorecard for my session, so that I know what to improve.	Medium	3
Epic 5: Privacy & Performance (NFR-001, NFR-002)				
5.1	Soft-Delete Data	As a user, I want my profile and scorecards soft-deleted within 24 hours of a request, so that my data stays private.	High	8
5.2	Fast Search	As a student, I want search results in under 2 seconds, so that browsing feels responsive.	Medium	5

Total backlog: 15 stories, 73 Story Points across 5 Epics.

3. Sprint Plan

Sprint 1	Students can find mentors and see their slots (1.1, 1.2, 2.2, 2.1)	4	21	1 week
Sprint 2	Students can book sessions safely (3.1, 3.2, 3.3)	3	21	1 week





4. Reflection Questions

1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Story Points were assigned using Fibonacci values. The Sprint 1 backlog contained 21 Story Points and Sprint 2 also contained 21 Story Points. The riskiest stories, mentor ranking (1.2) and calendar/meeting-link integration (3.3), were given 8 points because of their complexity and dependence on external services, while simple display stories received 2–3 points. Since this was a simulated sprint, the estimates represent relative effort. All planned stories were completed within their respective sprints.

2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Yes. The core student-facing functionality (domain selection, mentor recommendations, viewing availability, booking a session, and preventing double-booking) was given High priority because it forms the critical path of the platform. Supporting functionality such as mentor availability management and interview feedback was given Medium priority, and the no-match fallback was Low. Soft-deletion of user data (5.1) is High because of its privacy requirement and is the first candidate for Sprint 3.

3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

The work was divided into two sprints:

- Sprint 1: 4 stories — 21 Story Points
- Sprint 2: 3 stories — 21 Story Points

All planned stories were moved through To Do → In Progress → Done, and both sprints were completed successfully. Because the stories were moved manually over a short window, progress was more uniform than it would be in a real working week.

4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The burndown chart showed the remaining Story Points reducing as stories were completed. It gave a visual picture of progress against the guideline and showed that the planned workload of 21 Story Points per sprint was completed in each sprint. This suggests a working velocity of about 21 Story Points per one-week sprint, so the remaining backlog (31 points) would need roughly two more sprints at the same pace. Where the chart drops in steps rather than a smooth slope, it reflects stories being closed in bursts rather than steadily.